

Unintegrated Self: The Anti-Pattern That Arises When a Self Entity Lacks Genuine Integration Architecture per B1.05

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This work derives from and formalizes the instinct/reasoning separation pattern introduced in “The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model” (Li, April 2026), the second paper in the CKS theory series following “Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems” (Li, April 2026).

Abstract

The Coordination Knowledge Substrate (CKS) pattern commits the Self level to being an integrated whole — an entity that holds multiple aspects as facets of one CKS-governed intelligence, with authored integration architecture governing how aspects relate and how Self-level instinct/reasoning separation operates across them. The Unintegrated Self anti-pattern arises when a Self entity exists structurally — as the highest-level container in the three-level hierarchy — without the integration architecture that the B1.05 commitment requires. Three recognizable forms are identified: Nominal Self, where Self DNA carries no integration architecture; Isolated-Aspects Self, where aspects operate in parallel without cross-aspect conflict governance; and Configuration-Absent Self, where Self-level instinct/reasoning configuration per B2.23 is absent. Two emergence conditions recurrently produce the pattern: top-down structural design without integration work, and premature Self introduction before multiple aspects justify governance. Four operational consequences follow: ungoverned cross-aspect conflicts reaching operational output, absent instinct/reasoning governance at integration scope, evolution blocked at Self level, and composition invalidity. Detection uses four checks; remediation requires authoring the absent content through directed selection per B1.14 and running Self-level verification per B2.24.

1. The Commitment Violated

B1.05 commits the Self to being an integrated whole — not a structural label, not the largest container in the hierarchy, but an entity that genuinely holds multiple aspects as facets of one CKS-governed intelligence. The integration is architectural: it requires authored governance specifying how aspects relate, how cross-aspect conflicts are handled, how cross-level access is configured, and how the instinct/reasoning separation operates at integration scope.

B2.20 through B2.24 decompose this commitment into constituent obligations. B2.20 establishes the coexistence requirement: multiple aspects within one Self, potentially sharing cells across arrangements,

governed by the Self as one unified whole. B2.21 specifies Self integration architecture — the substrate-carried content that determines how the Self governs its aspects, including cross-aspect conflict handling rules, integration operation specifications, and cross-level access configuration. B2.22 establishes Self-aspect content-domain governance: each aspect operates over its constituent cells as content domain, and the Self holds those content domains under unified governance. B2.23 specifies the Self instinct/reasoning configuration — how the instinct/reasoning separation operates at integration scope, which LLM instances serve the instinct layer at Self scope, and how high-stakes identification functions for Self-level decisions. B2.24 provides the Self-level inheritance verification mechanism: the check that a candidate Self satisfies Paper 1 commitments at Self scope.

The Unintegrated Self anti-pattern names the failure mode in which a deployment positions an entity at the Self level — structurally occupying the integrated-whole position — while leaving absent, minimal, or nominal the integration architecture B2.21 specifies, the configuration B2.23 specifies, or both. The entity has the shape of a Self without the substance the commitment requires.

2. Pattern Name and Commitment Violated

Pattern name: Unintegrated Self

Commitment violated: B1.05 — Self as integrated whole holding multiple aspects as facets of one CKS-governed intelligence

Primary cross-references: B2.20 (aspect coexistence), B2.21 (Self integration architecture — the absent or nominal element in Forms 1 and 2), B2.22 (Self-aspect content-domain), B2.23 (Self instinct/reasoning configuration — the absent element in Form 3), B2.24 (Self-level inheritance verification), B1.14 (directed selection), A1.03 (conflict as first-class object), A1.13 (composition requirements)

3. Recognizable Forms

The Unintegrated Self manifests in three distinguishable forms. They share the core commitment violation but differ in what specifically is absent and in how the failure presents operationally.

3.1 Form 1 — Nominal Self

The Self entity exists as the highest-level structural container in the deployment. Self DNA is present — the entity is recognized as a Self by the architecture, carries a Self identifier, and may carry aspect references and Self-level metadata. But Self DNA is absent or minimal on the integration architecture dimensions B2.21 specifies: there are no authored cross-aspect conflict handling rules, no integration operation specifications, and no cross-level access configuration.

The Self is a label applied to the top of the hierarchy, not a governing integration entity. When two aspects under this Self produce outputs that concern the same operational territory — when a decision in one aspect implies or contradicts a decision in another — there is no Self-level governance determining how those outputs relate. The Self does not resolve the tension; it does not preserve it as a governed

conflict; it does not route it to the appropriate aspect authority. The tension propagates into operational output without governance.

Recognition signals for Form 1: B2.21 Self integration architecture is absent from Self DNA; the Self-level inheritance verification per B2.24 fails on integration architecture checks; aspects within the Self have no integration governance above them other than the nominal Self entity. A deployment review of the Self's substrate content finds aspect references and possibly Self-level metadata but no authored rules governing how aspects relate.

3.2 Form 2 — Isolated-Aspects Self

The Self contains multiple aspects, and those aspects operate. They produce outputs, execute over cells, and function within their respective content domains. But they function in parallel, without cross-aspect integration governance from the Self level.

The isolation becomes consequential when aspects' output territories overlap. An aspect responsible for one functional mode and an aspect responsible for another may both be active on an operational task that spans their domains. Each aspect produces its output according to its own governance; the Self has no authored rules for how those outputs are integrated, which takes precedence, or how cross-aspect conflicts are resolved. Conflicts accumulate in the cross-aspect conflict registry per A1.03 without Self-level governance addressing them. The operational output of the deployment reflects whichever aspect's output surfaces last, or whichever is given priority by runtime mechanics, rather than by authored integration governance.

This form is recognizable in deployments that evolved incrementally: a first aspect was deployed and functioned; a second aspect was introduced to handle an adjacent purpose; the Self level was used as a structural container to group them; integration governance was assumed to emerge or was deferred. The two aspects operate, but the Self as governing integration entity does not.

Recognition signals for Form 2: multiple aspects within the Self produce outputs on overlapping operational territories without authored conflict resolution; A1.03 cross-aspect conflicts accumulate in the conflict registry without Self-level governance entries; Self DNA has no cross-aspect output integration rules; when operational output is traced, the provenance path terminates at aspect level rather than at Self-level integration governance.

3.3 Form 3 — Configuration-Absent Self

The Self exists and carries integration architecture — it has authored rules in some dimensions, including perhaps basic cross-aspect routing or structural composition specifications. But B2.23 Self instinct/reasoning configuration is absent: the Self-level governance of how the instinct/reasoning separation operates across aspects has not been authored.

This form is distinct from Forms 1 and 2 because the Self has governance in some dimensions. The failure is specifically at the instinct/reasoning configuration layer. High-stakes identification for Self-level decisions has not been configured at Self scope. Self-level mutation governance — which

LLM instances serve the instinct layer at integration scope — is not specified. The Self's integration operations may route and resolve cross-aspect conflicts in some structural sense, but the instinct/reasoning separation that B2.23 requires to operate at integration scope is absent from Self DNA.

The consequence is that Self-level mutation governance per B2.62 through B2.66 cannot function at Self scope. The Self-level evolution mechanism lacks the configuration it requires; instinct-layer operations at integration scope proceed without the authored specification that distinguishes which model instances are serving which architectural role.

Recognition signals for Form 3: B2.23 Self instinct/reasoning configuration is absent from Self DNA; high-stakes identification at Self scope is not configured; Self-level mutation governance specifies nothing about LLM instances at integration scope; the Self passes some integration architecture checks but fails specifically on instinct/reasoning configuration checks.

4. Emergence Conditions

Two conditions recurrently produce the Unintegrated Self.

Top-down structural design without integration work. Architects designing a multi-aspect CKS deployment often begin by defining the structural hierarchy: cells, aspects, Self as the top-level container. Defining the Self structurally — naming it, registering it, establishing its aspect references — is work with clear completion criteria. Authoring the integration architecture is harder: it requires determining what cross-aspect conflicts are possible, what the resolution rules should be, what the instinct/reasoning configuration at integration scope needs to specify, and how cross-level access should be governed. These questions require operational knowledge about how aspects will interact at Self scope. Architects who cannot answer those questions at design time may defer them; the Self exists structurally while integration architecture remains absent. The structure is complete; the B1.05 commitment is not satisfied.

Premature Self introduction before multiple aspects justify integration governance. A deployment that begins with one aspect may introduce a Self prematurely — before a second aspect exists to justify integration governance. The Self is added as structural anticipation of future growth: the deployment is expected to expand to multiple aspects, and the Self level is established early so the hierarchy is ready when needed. With only one aspect, cross-aspect integration governance has no operational content yet. Integration architecture is deferred on the reasoning that it will be authored when the second aspect arrives. The second aspect is added under the premise that integration governance will follow; it does not, or it is authored minimally; and the Unintegrated Self emerges from the incremental deployment path. The Self level is established before the integration work that would give it substance.

5. Operational Consequences

Four consequences follow from absent integration architecture at Self level.

Ungoverned cross-aspect conflicts. Without Self-level integration governance, cross-aspect conflicts — situations where aspects produce competing or inconsistent outputs on the same operational concern — propagate to operational output without resolution. The deployment produces inconsistent or conflicting results for tasks that span multiple aspects. When operational outputs are traced, provenance terminates at aspect level; no Self-level integration governance appears in the trace. The A1.03 commitment to conflict as first-class object, which Paper 1’s recursive commitments carry through to every composition level, is violated at Self scope.

Absent instinct/reasoning governance at integration scope. Without B2.23 configuration, the Self-level instinct/reasoning separation is ungoverned. Self-level mutation governance per B2.62 through B2.66 cannot function: the specification of which LLM instances serve the instinct layer at integration scope is absent. Integration-scope operations that should be governed by authored instinct-layer specification proceed without the separation the commitment requires. The architectural property that the instinct/reasoning separation establishes at every composition level is absent at Self scope specifically, making Self-level behavior ungoverned in a dimension that is governed at cell and aspect scope.

Evolution blocked at Self level. Directed selection per B1.14 at Self scope — the mechanism through which Self-level integration architecture improves over time — requires integration architecture to exist as substrate content. Improvement through directed selection operates over authored content: humans compare alternatives, run verification, and select the better-performing configuration. Where integration architecture is absent from Self DNA, there is nothing for directed selection to act on at Self scope. The Self level cannot improve what it has never authored; Self-level evolution is structurally blocked so long as the Unintegrated Self condition persists.

Composition invalidity. Paper 1’s composition requirements per A1.13 apply at every level. Aspects within a Self must satisfy composition requirements governing their coexistence. Without Self-level integration architecture, aspects cannot satisfy those requirements: the integration governance that would make their coexistence architecturally coherent does not exist. The deployment may function operationally in a narrow sense while failing the composition commitments the architecture requires. Downstream deployments that compose with this Self inherit the composition invalidity.

6. Detection

Four checks identify the Unintegrated Self.

B2.21 integration architecture check. Is Self integration architecture present in Self DNA? Does it include authored cross-aspect conflict handling rules, integration operation specifications, and cross-level access configuration? A Self DNA review that finds aspect references but no integration governance content is positive for Form 1. A Self DNA review that finds governance content in some dimensions but not in cross-aspect conflict handling or integration operations is positive for Form 2.

B2.23 configuration check. Is Self instinct/reasoning configuration present in Self DNA? Does it specify high-stakes identification at Self scope? Does it specify mutation governance — which LLM instances serve the instinct layer at integration scope? Absence of any of these specifics, in a Self that

otherwise has some integration architecture, is positive for Form 3.

B2.24 Self-level inheritance verification. Does the Self satisfy Paper 1 commitments at Self scope? The B2.24 verification runs the commitments Paper 1 establishes through the Self level: substrate as source of truth, conflict as first-class object, human-governed, AI-as-substrate-mediator. An Unintegrated Self fails this verification at the integration architecture dimension: the substrate-as-source-of-truth commitment requires integration governance to be substrate content, and the conflict commitment requires conflict handling to be governed at every level, including Self scope.

A1.03 cross-aspect conflict registry review. Are cross-aspect conflicts accumulating in the conflict registry without Self-level resolution governance? A registry that shows aspect-level conflicts without corresponding Self-level governance entries is an operational signal. The conflicts are being recorded per the A1.03 commitment to conflict as first-class object; their accumulation without Self-level governance response indicates the integration governance required to address them is absent. The registry review is particularly reliable for detecting Form 2, where aspects are actively operating and cross-aspect conflicts are being generated.

7. Remediation

Remediation for the Unintegrated Self requires authoring what is absent. The sequence follows directed selection per B1.14 at Self scope.

For Form 1 (Nominal Self): Author Self integration architecture per B2.21 as Self DNA content. This requires determining the cross-aspect conflict handling rules for the actual aspects present, specifying the integration operations the Self performs when aspects interact on shared operational territory, and configuring cross-level access per the deployment's actual access requirements. The authored content becomes substrate content under human governance and is then subject to directed selection improvement over subsequent deployment cycles.

For Form 2 (Isolated-Aspects Self): Govern cross-aspect output integration explicitly. For each pairing of aspects whose output territories overlap, author rules in Self DNA specifying how outputs are integrated and how conflicts are resolved. Where conflicts cannot be resolved by rule, author escalation pathways per A1.03's two-level handling: substrate-level preservation of the conflict as a first-class object, with cell-level resolution under authored rules. The A1.03 cross-aspect conflict registry serves as the diagnostic input: conflicts already accumulating without governance identify the cross-aspect territories where integration governance must be authored first.

For Form 3 (Configuration-Absent Self): Author Self instinct/reasoning configuration per B2.23. Specify high-stakes identification for Self-level decisions: which operational conditions at integration scope trigger instinct-layer routing rather than reasoning-layer processing. Specify mutation governance at integration scope: which LLM instances serve the instinct layer for Self-level operations, and under what governance conditions mutation is permitted at Self scope. Add the authored configuration to Self DNA as substrate content, under the same human-governed authority architecture that governs all Self DNA content.

In all three forms, run B2.24 Self-level inheritance verification after remediation to confirm that the Self now satisfies Paper 1 commitments at Self scope. The verification check provides the confirmation criterion that remediation is complete rather than partial.

8. Conclusion

The Unintegrated Self names the failure to satisfy B1.05's commitment that a Self be a genuinely integrated whole, not merely a structural label at the top of the hierarchy. The commitment is not satisfied by positioning entities under a Self header or by having aspects that function independently within their own content domains. It is satisfied by authored integration architecture governing how aspects relate, how cross-aspect conflicts are handled, and how the instinct/reasoning separation operates at integration scope. Where that architecture is absent or nominal, the Self level provides none of the coordination function it exists to provide, and the deployment produces ungoverned cross-aspect conflicts, absent integration-scope governance, blocked Self-level evolution, and composition violations that propagate to any deployment that composes with the Self.

The three forms — Nominal Self, Isolated-Aspects Self, and Configuration-Absent Self — differ in what is absent and in how the failure presents operationally, but share the underlying violation: Self DNA does not carry what B1.05 requires. Detection is direct: the architecture check asks whether the authored content is present. Remediation is equally direct: author the absent content through directed selection per B1.14, then run B2.24 verification to confirm the commitment is satisfied.

Source Papers

Li, W. (2026). *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

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